CoffeeScript syntax and object system throughout this chapter.

4.10. Summary

JavaScript has a powerful object literal syntax that makes objects effective as generic data containers. The power of this literal syntax is evident in the rising popularity of JSON as a data exchange format for web applications. CoffeeScript takes full advantage of this syntax and, if you don’t like using curly braces even for object literals, the YAML-style syntax provides an even more succinct alternative.

The prototype-based object model has always been misunderstood in JavaScript. By exploring prototypes first and coming to CoffeeScript’s class syntax later as an organizing technique, you have a glimpse into the conceptual elegance of the little-known world of prototype-based object systems.

In the next chapter you’ll look deeper into the JavaScript object model and see how CoffeeScript syntax exposes the elegance and expressiveness within, without getting in your way. At the same time you’ll learn composition techniques and patterns for both prototype-based and class-based approaches.